

Verified

# FIFA World Cup

The FIFA World Cup began in Uruguay in 1930. It was not played in 1942 or 1946 because of the Second World War and its aftermath. The competition expanded over time from 13 teams in 1930 to 48 teams in 2026.

## FIFA World Cup editions, 1930 onward

| Year        | Host(s)                          | Teams | Winner       | Runner-up | Third   | Fourth / other semifinalist | Final                        |  |
|-------------|----------------------------------|-------|--------------|-----------|---------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|--|
| <u>2026</u> | Canada, Mexico and United States | 48    | <u>Spain</u> | Argentina | England | France                      | Spain 1-0 Argentina (a.e.t.) |  |

| Year        | Host(s)         | Teams | Winner           | Runner-up   | Third       | Fourth / other semifinalist | Final                                |
|-------------|-----------------|-------|------------------|-------------|-------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <u>2022</u> | Qatar           | 32    | <u>Argentina</u> | France      | Croatia     | Morocco                     | Argentina 3-3<br>France; 4-2<br>pens |
| <u>2018</u> | Russia          | 32    | <u>France</u>    | Croatia     | Belgium     | England                     | France 4-2<br>Croatia                |
| <u>2014</u> | Brazil          | 32    | <u>Germany</u>   | Argentina   | Netherlands | Brazil                      | Germany 1-0<br>Argentina<br>(a.e.t.) |
| <u>2010</u> | South<br>Africa | 32    | <u>Spain</u>     | Netherlands | Germany     | Uruguay                     | Spain 1-0<br>Netherlands<br>(a.e.t.) |

| <b>Year</b> | <b>Host(s)</b>              | <b>Teams</b> | <b>Winner</b>           | <b>Runner-up</b> | <b>Third</b> | <b>Fourth / other semifinalist</b> | <b>Final</b>                     |  |
|-------------|-----------------------------|--------------|-------------------------|------------------|--------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--|
| <u>2006</u> | Germany                     | 32           | <u>Italy</u>            | France           | Germany      | Portugal                           | Italy 1-1<br>France; 5-3<br>pens |  |
| <u>2002</u> | South<br>Korea and<br>Japan | 32           | <u>Brazil</u>           | Germany          | Türkiye      | South Korea                        | Brazil 2-0<br>Germany            |  |
| <u>1998</u> | France                      | 32           | <u>France</u>           | Brazil           | Croatia      | Netherlands                        | France 3-0<br>Brazil             |  |
| <u>1994</u> | United<br>States            | 24           | <u>Brazil</u>           | Italy            | Sweden       | Bulgaria                           | Brazil 0-0 Italy;<br>3-2 pens    |  |
| <u>1990</u> | Italy                       | 24           | <u>West<br/>Germany</u> | Argentina        | Italy        | England                            | West Germany<br>1-0 Argentina    |  |

| Year        | Host(s)         | Teams | Winner                  | Runner-up    | Third           | Fourth / other semifinalist | Final                                    |
|-------------|-----------------|-------|-------------------------|--------------|-----------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| <u>1986</u> | Mexico          | 24    | <u>Argentina</u>        | West Germany | France          | Belgium                     | Argentina 3-2<br>West Germany            |
| <u>1982</u> | Spain           | 24    | <u>Italy</u>            | West Germany | Poland          | France                      | Italy 3-1 West<br>Germany                |
| <u>1978</u> | Argentina       | 16    | <u>Argentina</u>        | Netherlands  | Brazil          | Italy                       | Argentina 3-1<br>Netherlands<br>(a.e.t.) |
| <u>1974</u> | West<br>Germany | 16    | <u>West<br/>Germany</u> | Netherlands  | Poland          | Brazil                      | West Germany<br>2-1<br>Netherlands       |
| <u>1970</u> | Mexico          | 16    | <u>Brazil</u>           | Italy        | West<br>Germany | Uruguay                     | Brazil 4-1 Italy                         |

| <b>Year</b> | <b>Host(s)</b> | <b>Teams</b> | <b>Winner</b>           | <b>Runner-up</b> | <b>Third</b> | <b>Fourth / other semifinalist</b> | <b>Final</b>                            |  |
|-------------|----------------|--------------|-------------------------|------------------|--------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--|
| <u>1966</u> | England        | 16           | <u>England</u>          | West Germany     | Portugal     | Soviet Union                       | England 4-2<br>West Germany<br>(a.e.t.) |  |
| <u>1962</u> | Chile          | 16           | <u>Brazil</u>           | Czechoslovakia   | Chile        | Yugoslavia                         | Brazil 3-1<br>Czechoslovakia            |  |
| <u>1958</u> | Sweden         | 16           | <u>Brazil</u>           | Sweden           | France       | West Germany                       | Brazil 5-2<br>Sweden                    |  |
| <u>1954</u> | Switzerland    | 16           | <u>West<br/>Germany</u> | Hungary          | Austria      | Uruguay                            | West Germany<br>3-2 Hungary             |  |

| Year        | Host(s) | Teams | Winner         | Runner-up      | Third            | Fourth / other semifinalist | Final                                           |
|-------------|---------|-------|----------------|----------------|------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <u>1950</u> | Brazil  | 13    | <u>Uruguay</u> | Brazil         | Sweden           | Spain                       | Uruguay 2-1<br>Brazil (final-<br>group decider) |
| <u>1938</u> | France  | 15    | <u>Italy</u>   | Hungary        | Brazil           | Sweden                      | Italy 4-2<br>Hungary                            |
| <u>1934</u> | Italy   | 16    | <u>Italy</u>   | Czechoslovakia | Germany          | Austria                     | Italy 2-1<br>Czechoslovakia<br>(a.e.t.)         |
| <u>1930</u> | Uruguay | 13    | <u>Uruguay</u> | Argentina      | United<br>States | Yugoslavia                  | Uruguay 4-2<br>Argentina                        |

**Podium by edition**

**2026**

Hosted by Canada, Mexico and United States

-  **Spain**
-  Argentina
-  England
- 4. France

**2022**

Hosted by Qatar

-  **Argentina**
-  France
-  Croatia
- 4. Morocco

**2018**

Hosted by Russia

-  **France**
-  Croatia
-  Belgium
- 4. England

**2014**

Hosted by Brazil

-  **Germany**
-  Argentina
-  Netherlands
- 4. Brazil

**2010**

Hosted by South Africa

-  **Spain**
-  Netherlands
-  Germany
- 4. Uruguay

**2006**

Hosted by Germany

-  **Italy**
-  France
-  Germany
- 4. Portugal

**2002**

Hosted by South Korea and Japan

-  **Brazil**
-  Germany
-  Türkiye
- 4. South Korea

**1998**

Hosted by France

-  **France**
-  Brazil
-  Croatia
- 4. Netherlands

**1994**

Hosted by United States

-  **Brazil**
-  Italy
-  Sweden
- 4. Bulgaria

**1990**

Hosted by Italy

**1986**

Hosted by Mexico

**1982**

Hosted by Spain

 **West Germany**

 Argentina

 Italy

4. England

 **Argentina**

 West Germany

 France

4. Belgium

 **Italy**

 West Germany

 Poland

4. France

**1978**

Hosted by Argentina

 **Argentina**

 Netherlands

 Brazil

4. Italy

**1974**

Hosted by West Germany

 **West Germany**

 Netherlands

 Poland

4. Brazil

**1970**

Hosted by Mexico

 **Brazil**

 Italy

 West Germany

4. Uruguay

**1966**

Hosted by England

 **England**

 West Germany

 Portugal

4. Soviet Union

**1962**

Hosted by Chile

 **Brazil**

 Czechoslovakia

 Chile

4. Yugoslavia

**1958**

Hosted by Sweden

 **Brazil**

 Sweden

 France

4. West Germany

**1954**

Hosted by Switzerland

**1950**

Hosted by Brazil

**1938**

Hosted by France



|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>West Germany</b><br> Hungary<br> Austria<br>4. Uruguay                                    |  <b>Uruguay</b><br> Brazil<br> Sweden<br>4. Spain                                                     |  <b>Italy</b><br> Hungary<br> Brazil<br>4. Sweden |
| <b>1934</b><br>Hosted by Italy<br> <b>Italy</b><br> Czechoslovakia<br> Germany<br>4. Austria | <b>1930</b><br>Hosted by Uruguay<br> <b>Uruguay</b><br> Argentina<br> United States<br>4. Yugoslavia |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

 **Champions by titles**

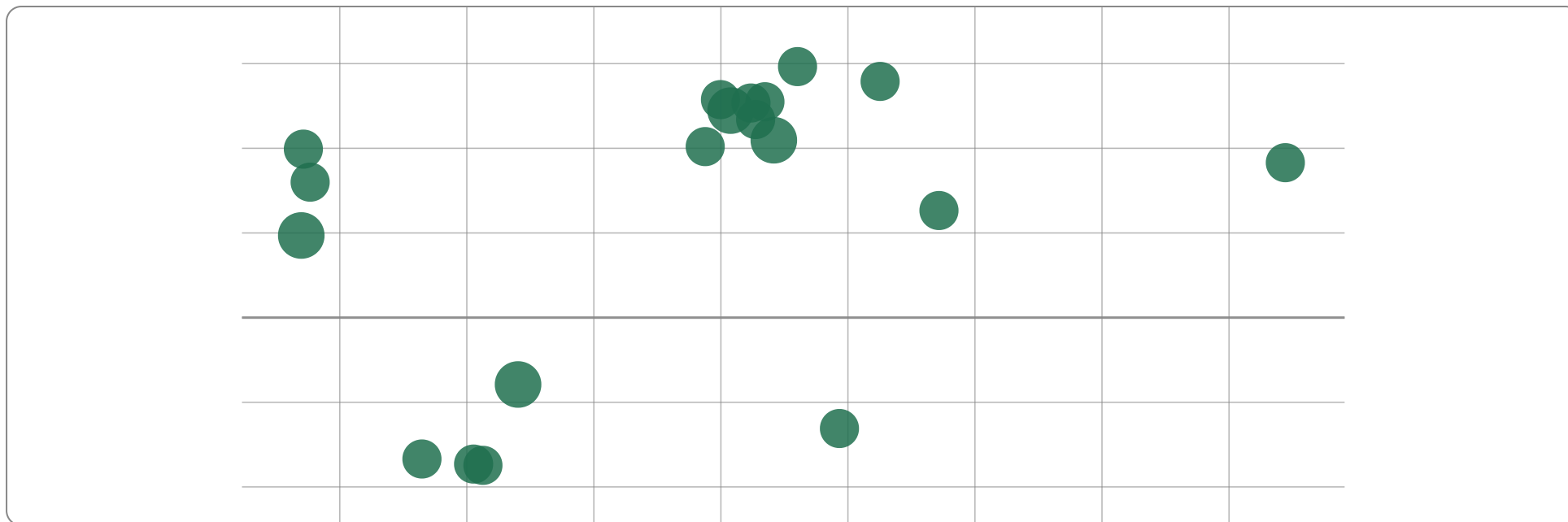
Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

|                                                                                                                                                      |   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| <b>Brazil</b><br><br>1958, 1962, 1970, 1994, 2002                 | 5 |
| <b>Italy</b><br><br>1934, 1938, 1982, 2006                        | 4 |
| <b>Germany (incl. West Germany)</b><br><br>1954, 1974, 1990, 2014 | 4 |

|                                                     |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Argentina</b><br><div></div><br>1978, 1986, 2022 | <b>3</b> |
| <b>Uruguay</b><br><div></div><br>1930, 1950         | <b>2</b> |
| <b>France</b><br><div></div><br>1998, 2018          | <b>2</b> |
| <b>Spain</b><br><div></div><br>2010, 2026           | <b>2</b> |
| <b>England</b><br><div></div><br>1966               | <b>1</b> |

**Where the tournament has been hosted**

Every host country's approximate location on a simple latitude/longitude grid, grouped by region in the list below - not a claim of exact borders, just roughly where in the world each edition took place. Bigger dots hosted more than once.



## South America

**Uruguay** 1 time  
1930

**Brazil** 2 times  
1950, 2014

**Chile** 1 time  
1962

**Argentina** 1 time  
1978

## Europe

**Italy** 2 times  
1934, 1990

**France** 2 times  
1938, 1998

**Switzerland** 1 time  
1954

**Sweden** 1 time  
1958

**England** 1 time  
1966

**West Germany** 1 time  
1974

## North America

**Mexico** 2 times  
1970, 1986

**United States** 1 time  
1994

**Canada, Mexico and United States** 1 time  
2026

## Asia

**South Korea and Japan** 1 time  
2002

**Qatar** 1 time  
2022

**Spain** 1 time

1982

**Germany** 1 time

2006

**Russia** 1 time

2018

## **Africa**

**South Africa** 1 time

2010

## **How it works**

- National teams first play years of qualifying matches within their own confederation to win one of a limited number of finals places.
- The finals begin with a group stage, where each team plays the others in its group; the leading teams advance.
- From the round of 16 onward, it is a straight knockout: one defeat and a team is out.
- The two semifinal winners meet in the final to decide the champion.
- The tournament has expanded several times since 1930 - see "Format milestones" below for exactly when.

## **Format milestones**

- **1930:** 13 teams played the first edition.
- **1950:** no single final was scheduled; the decisive final-group match between Uruguay and Brazil determined the champion.
- **1982:** the field expanded from 16 to 24 teams.
- **1998:** the field expanded to 32 teams.
- **2026:** the field expanded to 48 teams and was hosted by three countries for the first time.

## **Memorable moments**

- Uruguay defeated Brazil in the decisive 1950 match at the Maracanã, a result remembered as the *Maracanazo*.
- Brazil's 1970 side became the first team to win three World Cups.
- Diego Maradona inspired Argentina in 1986.
- Croatia reached its first final in 2018.
- Argentina and France played a 3–3 final in 2022 before Argentina won the shoot-out.
- Spain won its second title in 2026.



## Editorial notes

- The 1930 tournament did not include a third-place match. FIFA's historical ranking places the United States third and Yugoslavia fourth.
- The 1950 final positions came from a four-team final group rather than semifinals and a final.
- “Germany” totals conventionally include West Germany's results.



## References & review

**Status: verified**

Last reviewed: 14 August 2026

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- \*\*One discrepancy found and fixed:\*\* the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/spain-argentina-final-report-highlights>).
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- \*\*One discrepancy found and fixed:\*\* the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/2026-fifa-world-cup-final-spain-argentina-sunday/>)
- \*\*One discrepancy found and fixed:\*\* the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/france-england-report-highlights-bronze-final>)
- \*\*One discrepancy found and fixed:\*\* the Final column read "Spain 1-0 ([https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/\\_/gameId/760516/england-france](https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760516/england-france))
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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.